



Innocent Chilongo

SOMMELIER

Details

Franschhoek, Western Cape

South Africa

0730073927

chilongoinnocent73@gmail.com

Skills

Wine Expertise: Extensive knowledge of wine regions, grape varieties, production methods, and tasting techniques.

Food and Wine Pairing: Proficient in creating and recommending complementary wine pairings to enhance dining experiences.

Customer Service Excellence: Skilled in delivering exceptional service to guests, building rapport, and fostering loyalty.

Inventory Management: Skilled in maintaining and managing stock levels to ensure operational efficiency.

Communication and Storytelling: Capable of engaging guests with compelling stories about wines, their origins, and production methods.

Public Health & Sanitation Compliance

Profile

Luxury hospitality sommelier with distinguished experience across prestigious wine estates and high-end fine dining. Proven track record in driving beverage revenue growth through premium wine and drinks package upselling while delivering exceptional guest experiences. Skilled in wine education and tasting experiences, premium service standards, cellar management, inventory control, and operational efficiency. Polished communicator with a refined guest first approach, deep product knowledge and professionalism. Trusted to elevate service, boost spend, and protect luxury brand standards always

Employment History

Sommelier, Plaisir Wine Estate

AUG 2021 – PRESENT

- Deliver immersive wine tasting experiences by showcasing Plaisir's award-winning wines, emphasizing estate-specific terroir, sustainable farming practices, and the winemaking philosophy to educate and engage guests.
- Customize wine recommendations based on guest preferences, enhancing satisfaction and driving direct-to-consumer sales and wine club sign-ups.
- Collaborate closely with the sales and marketing teams to develop storytelling-driven content for tastings, private events, and digital campaigns, reinforcing Plaisir's brand identity and increasing visibility.
- Manage and execute private events, including cellar tours and wine-pairing dinners, ensuring seamless logistics and elevated guest experiences that reflect Plaisir's luxury standards.
- Lead junior tasting room staff in service excellence, product knowledge, and upselling techniques, maintaining consistency in premium hospitality.
- Monitor and control stock levels, glassware, and cellar presentation to maintain Plaisir's impeccable service standards and operational readiness.
- Promote Bartinney's commitment to sustainability and biodiversity through storytelling during tastings and tours, reinforcing the estate's position as a leader in eco-conscious winemaking.

Wine Steward, Le Franschhoek Hotel & Spa

DEC 2019 – MAR 2020

- Drive beverage revenue through strategic upselling of wine, spirits and cocktails during Lunch and Dinner time.
- Deliver premium wine service and pairing recommendations to elevate guest dining experience.
- Upsell after-dinner beverages (digestifs, liqueurs, premium spirits) to increase venue sales targets.
- Support daily service operations across breakfast, lunch, and dinner including hot beverages and bar service.
- Prioritized a customer-first approach, ensuring active sales promotion focusing on guest satisfaction.

Education

Certificate in Wine, Cape Wine Academy, Stellenbosch

OCT 2021

Level 2, Wine and Spirit Educational Trust (WSET)

NOV 2021 – FEB 2026